Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-11-12

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Amos 5:18-27

18 Woe to you who desire the day of the LORD! For what good is the day of the LORD to you? It will be darkness, and not light.

19 It will be as though a man fled from a lion, And a bear met him! Or as though he went into the house, Leaned his hand on the wall, And a serpent bit him!

20 Is not the day of the LORD darkness, and not light? Is it not very dark, with no brightness in it?

21 “I hate, I despise your feast days, And I do not savor your sacred assemblies.

22 Though you offer Me burnt offerings and your grain offerings, I will not accept them, Nor will I regard your fattened peace offerings.

23 Take away from Me the noise of your songs, For I will not hear the melody of your stringed instruments.

24 But let justice run down like water, And righteousness like a mighty stream.

25 “Did you offer Me sacrifices and offerings In the wilderness forty years, O house of Israel?

26 You also carried Sikkuth your king And Chiun, your idols, The star of your gods, Which you made for yourselves.

27 Therefore I will send you into captivity beyond Damascus,” Says the LORD, whose name is the God of hosts.

II. Key Summary

• Verses 18–20 say woe to those who desire the day of the LORD; it will be darkness and not light, as though a man fled from a lion and a bear met him, or went into the house, leaned his hand on the wall, and a serpent bit him.

• In verses 21–24 the LORD says He hates and despises their feast days, does not savor their sacred assemblies, will not accept their burnt offerings and grain offerings, and will not hear their songs and stringed instruments; but let justice run down like water, and righteousness like a mighty stream.

• In verses 25–27 the LORD asks the house of Israel whether they offered Him sacrifices and offerings in the wilderness forty years, says they carried idols which they made for themselves, and therefore He will send them into captivity beyond Damascus.

III. Passage Analysis

"Woe to You Who Desire the Day of the LORD"

> The people had always thought that "the day of the LORD" was the time when their enemies would be defeated, the chosen people saved, and exalted among the nations. But the prophet points out: for a people who do not practice justice, this day is a day of judgment, and no one can escape. [1]

They desired the day of the LORD, waiting for God to act against their enemies; but verses 18 and 20 say that day is "darkness, and not light," and verse 19, fleeing a lion only to meet a bear, going into the house only to be bitten by a serpent, shows that the punishment cannot be escaped [2].

They were waiting for God to judge others, but that day would count them in too.

"Let Justice Run Down Like Water"

> "Justice" and "righteousness" are the prerequisites for people to be accepted by God. These are exactly the principles the Israelites despised and cast away (v. 7); without them, how could a people who had left the right way come before God? [2]

The feast days, burnt offerings, and songs of verses 21–23, the LORD accepts none of them; in verse 24 what He wants is justice like water and righteousness like a mighty stream. In the previous passage, verse 7, they "lay righteousness to rest in the earth."

The righteousness they had laid down in the earth is exactly what God wants to flow like a stream that never stops.

IV. Reflection Question

Why do you mainly go to Sunday service and small group, sing, give offerings, and serve? If God said to you, "I will not accept them," what do you think the reason would be?

Israel's feasts and sacrifices were held on a grand scale, yet they only took the chance to enjoy themselves, with no humble, repentant heart before God [3]; the LORD said, "Though you offer Me burnt offerings and your grain offerings, I will not accept them." (v. 22) The people no longer had the substance of justice and righteousness in their lives, only outward ritual, and God would never accept it [2].

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Resources (ccbiblestudy.org), Chain-Reference Bible Commentary (串珠聖經註釋), Amos 5 notes, https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/30Amos/30GT05.htm

[2] Chinese Christian Bible Study Resources (ccbiblestudy.org), Chinese Study Bible notes (啟導本註釋), Amos 5 notes, https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/30Amos/30GT05.htm

[3] Chinese Christian Bible Study Resources (ccbiblestudy.org), Tien Dao Bible Commentary: Amos (天道聖經注釋 – 阿摩司書) by 唐佑之, Amos 5 notes, https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/30Amos/30GT05.htm